

Evril Bilgen

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SUMMARY

Technical Product Manager working on AI, LLM and search products. 10+ years in product after 5 years as a software engineer. Built RAG and search over 2M+ documents, ML scoring and segmentation products, and a platform serving 38M users. Led teams of 10 to 50+ and coached junior PMs across telecom, fintech, insurance and B2B SaaS.

EXPERIENCE

Technical Product Manager (Contract), Self-employed

Remote | Aug 2025 - Present

AI product work for B2B SaaS and early-stage teams, from discovery to production.

- **Agentic RAG research assistant:** Insurance analysts were losing hours searching across disconnected PDF libraries. Led the build of an agent that breaks complex questions into sub-queries, calls retrieval tools through MCP (search, fetch document, metadata) and answers with claim-level citations from 500K+ internal documents. MVP delivered to 3 clients, now shaping the roadmap for a Series A startup.
- **Evaluation:** Set up evals in three layers with RAGAS and Langfuse: retrieval, answer faithfulness and citation grounding. The first results showed the weak point was retrieval, not the model. Prioritized hybrid search (BM25 + embeddings) and reranking over prompt changes, which improved grounding and cut unsupported claims.
- **Ludex, game search and recommendation agent:** Steam search breaks on requests like "co-op horror for 4 players under \$15, not too scary". Built an agent that turns requests like this into clear constraints, searches a public Steam catalog through MCP tools (keyword and semantic search, filters, reranking) and explains each pick with the data behind it. Evaluated on a 200-query test set for retrieval quality, constraint accuracy and answer faithfulness, tracked in Langfuse.
- **LLM-powered SDK generator:** Generates Python, TypeScript and Java SDKs from OpenAPI specs, cutting update cycles for 2 B2B clients from 2-3 days to under 4 hours.

Senior Product Manager, ISI Emerging Markets / EMIS

Warsaw, Poland | Aug 2022 - Aug 2025

B2B SaaS platform for financial and industry research across emerging markets. Led project teams of 20+ on initiatives running about a year each.

- **Search relevance and latency:** APAC users waited up to 5 seconds per query, and 30% of churned trials named search as the reason. Instead of adding more caching, pulled the query logs first and used behavioural clustering to find where the long tail broke, then fixed Elasticsearch, caching and pagination in that order. P95 latency fell 18%, zero-result queries fell 34% and trial-to-paid conversion rose from 8.5% to 9.5%.
- **AI research layer:** The platform's 2M+ PDF reports could not be queried together, which capped how deep analysts could go. Made the case for natural language search across the full library and led the team through it. Analyst research time dropped 40% and power-user retention rose 23% within six months.
- **API platform:** Undocumented, inconsistent APIs stretched client integrations to 6 weeks. Worked with client teams to find where they got stuck, then drove an OpenAPI refactor with clear contracts and self-service docs. Integration time dropped to 10 days and 40+ enterprise clients adopted the platform.
- **Data-driven roadmap:** Roadmap decisions went to whichever request was loudest. Defined platform KPIs (query success rate, time-to-insight, engagement depth), shipped real-time dashboards and moved a 10-15 person team to data-driven prioritisation.

Senior Product Manager, BR-AG (now Regnology)

Poznan, Poland | Feb 2022 - Aug 2022

Global FinTech platform for regulatory reporting. Onboarded and mentored a junior PM.

- **Regulatory submissions:** COREP and FINREP submissions were failing validation at high rates, putting client SLAs at risk. Redesigned the data contracts to standardise submission formats and delivered ML-based risk flagging to catch errors before they reached regulators. Validation failures dropped sharply and submission cycles sped up.
- **Self-service data:** Compliance teams depended on engineering for every data query. Separated what compliance needed from what engineering was being asked to build, then delivered self-service SQL tooling. Engineering requests dropped and both teams moved faster before deadlines.

Senior Product Manager, MIRA

WA, USA | Mar 2020 - Nov 2021

AI startup building behavioural scoring products for video game studios. Most senior product person. Led a team of 4 data scientists, 6 engineers and QA, and set up the product process from scratch.

- **Retention and monetisation:** Game studios could not tell which trial players would convert or churn. Owned an ML propensity scoring product built on session and login signals that flagged at-risk players before they left. Trial-to-paid conversion rose and churn fell within the first quarter.
- **Experiments:** Validated the model with A/B tests before rollout and tied scoring outcomes to conversion through OKRs.

- **Roadmap decisions:** Took scoring from concept to a production microservice (FastAPI, Kubernetes). Sales used the score inside HubSpot and other teams adopted the API.

Senior Product Manager, Turkcell Group

Istanbul, Turkey | Oct 2017 - Nov 2019

Turkey's largest telecom operator. Directly managed a core team of 8 within a 50+ cross-functional group. Onboarded and mentored 2 junior PMs.

- **Platform modernisation:** The CRM and billing platform for 38M subscribers was a monolith. Deployments took over 4 hours and any change carried system-wide risk. Led the move to microservices starting with the Customer Profile service, with CI/CD and observability (ELK, Grafana). Deployment time fell to under 30 minutes, peak-load incidents fell 60% and release cycles shortened from 6+ weeks to 2-3 weeks.
- **ML segmentation:** Campaign targeting for millions of users took days, which made real-time personalisation impossible. Led delivery of an ML customer segmentation engine with engineering and data teams, and set OpenAPI contracts and OKRs across teams. Targeting cycles dropped from days to hours.

Senior Product Owner, Allianz

Istanbul, Turkey | Sep 2015 - Oct 2017

Global insurance company.

- **Mobile health insurance app:** Policyholders had web access but no mobile app. Led a 20+ person team to take a mobile health insurance platform from 0 to 1, running discovery with the claims team and customers to prioritise claim submission, doctor search and policy overview. Reached 65% mobile adoption within 6 months and reduced call centre load.
- **API integration:** Legacy policy systems had no API layer. Drove OAuth2-secured integrations that connected the app to core policy systems for real-time policy lookup, cutting claim processing time.

Senior Software Analyst Developer, Logo Business

Istanbul, Turkey | Oct 2013 - Sep 2015

Built SaaS e-invoice modules (ASP.NET, C#) that integrated with multiple ERP systems.

Software Developer, Axa Insurance

Istanbul, Turkey | Oct 2010 - Oct 2013

Built enterprise financial reporting systems (ASP.NET, PL/SQL, T-SQL) that automated monthly reports for finance teams.

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science and Business Analytics, University of Warsaw

2020 - 2023

BSc Mathematics and Computer Programming, Maltepe University

2003 - 2007

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner | Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) | Google UX Design Certificate

SKILLS

Search: Elasticsearch, Relevance and Ranking, Query Understanding, Zero-Result Analysis, Hybrid Search, Vector Search, Reranking

LLM and Agentic AI: RAG, Agentic Workflows, MCP, Citation and Grounding, LLM Evaluation (RAGAS, Langfuse), Prompt Engineering, LangChain, Hugging Face, Claude

Data and ML: Python, SQL, Predictive Scoring, Behavioural Clustering, A/B Testing, Experiment Design

Platform and APIs: API Design, OpenAPI, SDK Automation, Microservices, FastAPI

Product: Product Strategy, AI Product Lifecycle, OKRs, User Research, Agile

Cloud: AWS, CI/CD, ELK, Grafana

LANGUAGES AND WORK AUTHORISATION

Languages: English (C1), Turkish (Native)

Work authorisation: Turkish citizen. Studied, lived and worked abroad for years in international teams. Open to relocation (EU Blue Card eligible) or remote.